

Data Selection

Sometimes we want to work with only a portion of the data.

Data Selection

Data → Select Cases

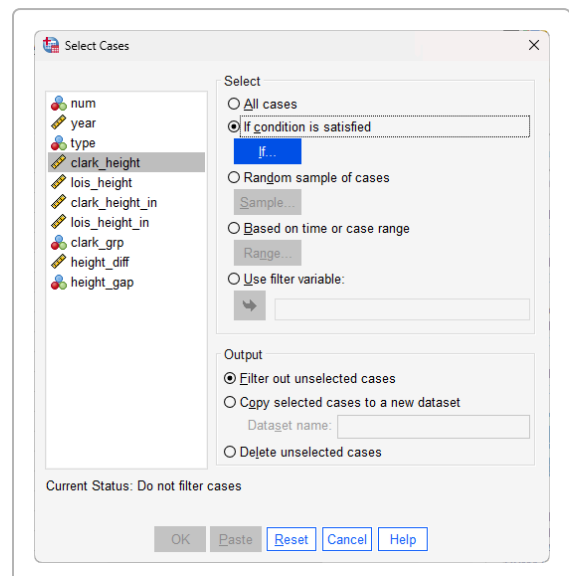
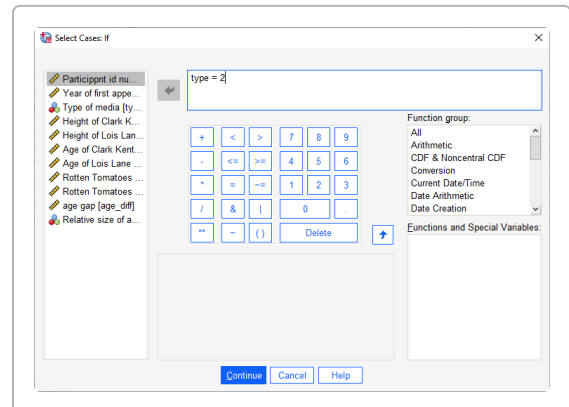
Example: We want to analyze just the data from TV Show portrayals (`type = 2`).

1. Click the “If condition is satisfied” radio button
2. Click the “If...” button
3. Highlight the variable name and click the arrow to move it into the window
4. Use the buttons or type the conditional statement (e.g., `type = 2`)
5. Click “Continue”, then “OK”

SPSS Syntax

```
USE ALL.
COMPUTE filter_$=(type = 2).
VARIABLE LABELS filter_$ 'type =
2 (FILTER)'.
VALUE LABELS filter_$ 0 'Not
Selected' 1 'Selected'.
FORMATS filter_$ (f1.0).
FILTER BY filter_$.
EXE.
```

- ① Create a filter variable based on the condition (e.g., `type = 2` selects TV Shows)
- ② Label the filter variable for clarity in outputs
- ③ Define value labels so SPSS displays “Not Selected” and “Selected”
- ④ Apply the filter — only selected cases will be used in subsequent analyses



! Important

To return to analyzing all data: Go back to Select Cases and click “All Cases”,
or run: `FILTER OFF. USE ALL. EXE.`

	type	clark_height	lois_height	clark_age	lois_age	rt_criticism_score	rt_audience_score	age_diff	age_gap3	filter_\$	var	var	var
1	1	75.98	1.60	32.01	35.00	83.00	90.00	-2.99	1.00	0			
2	1	75.98	1.72	26.22	30.16	88.00	86.00	-3.94	1.00	0			
3	2	74.80	1.71	24.47	23.32	78.00	72.00	1.15	1.00	1			
4	1	74.11	1.65	26.72	23.48	72.00	69.00	3.24	2.00	0			
5	1	73.23	1.63	37.84	24.81	-99.00	79.00	13.03	3.00	0			
6	1	72.83	1.63	30.11	38.82	57.00	75.00	-8.71	1.00	0			
7	3	72.83	1.62	37.24	27.11	83.00	90.00	10.13	3.00	0			
8	2	71.65	1.68	33.45	40.10	88.00	84.00	-6.65	1.00	1			
9	2	71.26	1.68	27.12	28.76	85.00	85.00	-1.64	1.00	1			
10	2	72.05	-99.00	22.76	-99.00	-99.00	-99.00			1			
11	2	72.05	-99.00	30.50	-99.00	-99.00	-99.00			1			
12													
13													
14													
15													
16													
17													
18													

Split Files

Sometimes we want to get separate analyses for each of the “subsets” or “sub-groups” in our data.

Split Files

Data → Split File

Example: We want to analyze the data for the three types of media (Film, TV Show, Serial) separately.

1. Click either “Compare groups” or “Organize output by groups”
2. Highlight the grouping variable and click the arrow to move it into “Groups Based on:”
3. Click “OK”

SPSS Syntax

```
SORT CASES BY type.
SPLIT FILE SEPARATE BY type.
```

- ① Sort data by the grouping variable first (required before splitting)
- ② Split the file so analyses run separately for each group (use `LAYERED` for side-by-side output)

 Tip**Which output option?**

- **Compare groups:** First part of output for all groups, then second part for all groups, etc.
- **Organize output by groups:** All output for group 1, then all output for group 2, etc.

Use **LAYERED** instead of **SEPARATE** for “Compare groups” output.

Unsplit a file

To return to analyzing all data together: Go back to Split File and click “Analyze all cases, do not create groups”, or run: **SPLIT FILE OFF.**

